

SARPHU BROOM GRASS MANAGEMENT AND MARKETING GROUP (1st Revision)

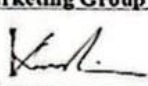
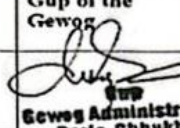
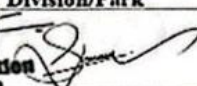
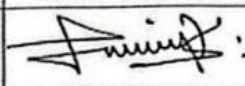
**Sarphu, Hatitar and Khampola Village
Darla Geog
Chhukha Dzongkhag**

Plan Period: 2024-2034

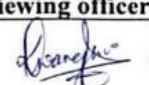
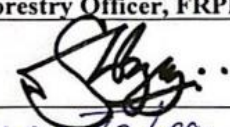
APPROVAL SHEET

Name of the NWFP management and marketing group	Sarphu Broom Grass Management and Marketing Group
Dzongkhag	Chhukha
Gewog	Darla
Village(s)	Sarphu, Hatitat, Gairigoan and Khampula
No. of households	14
Area	6 ha (15acres)
Plan period	2024-2034

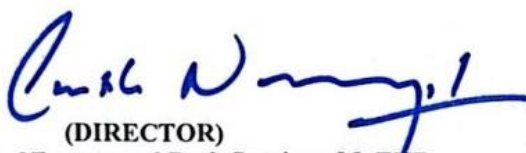
Prepared and submitted for approval

	Chairperson NWFP Management & Marketing Group	Gup of the Gewog	Head, Social Forestry Section of Division/Park	Chief Forestry Officer of Division/Park
Signature:				
Name:	Kaziman Rai	Rinchen Dorji	Sonam Lhendup	Rinzin Dorji
Date:	1/6/2024	5/6/2024	10/6/2024	10/6/2024

Reviewed and recommended for Approval

	Reviewing officer, FRPMD	Chief Forestry Officer, FRPMD
Signature		
Name	Kezang Wangmo	Sonam Tshenpa
Date	22-07-2024	25/07/24

Approved by:



(DIRECTOR)

Department of Forests and Park Services, MoENR

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Part A: NWFP Management and Marketing Plan**1. Background**

Sarphu Chiwog is located to the south of Darla Gewog sharing the international boundary with the Indian state of Assam. The Chiwog have a total population of **297** residing in **43** households within the 4 villages of Sarphu, Hatitar, Gairigoan, and Khampula. Initially, out of 43 households, 31 HHs have come forward to form a non-wood forest product group and cultivated broom grass on their private land. However, the number of group members is reduced to 14 in this revised plan. The withdrawal of group members was primarily attributed to the shortage of household members living in the village.

The group was registered and approved in the year 2012 as a farmers' group under the Department of Agriculture Marketing and Co-operatives. The management plan expired its initial period of five years on the 30th of June, 2017.

Based on the requirement of the group's constitution and by-laws, the plan was reviewed by the group with technical and legal support from the Divisional Forest Office, Gedu and Gewog Administration on 7th December 2017. The results of the reviews indicated that the business of the Broom has significantly benefited after the decline of the orange as a primary cash crop. However, the broom grass business has become a secondary source of income apart from areca nut, ginger, pineapple, and goat rearing.

The books of account maintained by the group revealed that the group has maintained the highest level of transparency, accountability, and equity while sharing benefits among the group members, especially during disbursing a loan. It was evident that borrowers benefitted in buying school stationeries and school uniforms for students. However, the major challenges faced by the group were access to the market, lack of storage house, and transport mechanisms. Further, the challenges of human-wildlife conflict have drastically reduced the area of cultivation as wild elephants and monkeys are feeding on the broom grass.

The revised management plan of Sarphu Broom Grass Group focuses on addressing these issues and challenges encountered during the earlier plan period specifically on the group's practice of a collection of brooms, stocking, and on marketing strategies. Also, the revised plan has friendly rules to support and enhance women's participation in decision-making and for taking key functional roles in the group. The overall objective of the revised plan has been to make more ease in management and operation of the broom business and to promote better income for the group and individual members. This plan document has been prepared after thorough review and discussion with all members and based on experience gained from five years and all the amendments and additions carried out with unanimous agreement during the process of plan revision.

2. Overall management Goals and Objectives

- To sustainably manage the Broom Grass as an alternative income source for citrus dieback.
- To increase community income through the sale of brooms.
- To enhance community cooperation and coordination.
- To empower the community in NWFP (broom) management.
- To expand the area for Broom Grass cultivation in the future from private Registered land to Government Reserved Forest for maximizing income.
- To conserve Forests and the environment under the Broom Grass Management initiatives.

3. History of First Two Management and Marketing Plan Cycle.

The Group has mainly focused their First two Management Plan cycle on planting the desired broom grass like *Thysanolaena latifolia* (Kuchu (lh) in their registered private land and marketing in the local market as well as exporting to the nearest Indian market. The broom grass management has become an important source of income in the Chiwog. Over the past ten years, the group could produce 48327 bundles of brooms generating Nu.793,528.46 as income which has immensely benefited in enhancing community livelihood. Also, it has helped in making the best use of lands that were once left fallow due to low fertility and water shortages as the grass grows well even in these conditions. The grass has helped protect runoff during heavy rain and become an important fodder for livestock during the lean season. However, the recent human-wildlife conflict like elephants and monkeys feeding extensively on the broom grass shoots at early stages have impacted the production and morale of communities for cultivating the broom grass. Further, the market opportunity during the pandemic has left the communities with uncertainty about the market in the future. Nevertheless, owing to the several benefits of broom grass cultivation, farmers opted to continue with group formation.

The Sarphu Broom management group has earned the revenue as follows:

Table 1. Revenue generated by the Group after the its establishment till date

Sl.No.	Year	Income (Nu.)
1	2012-2013	39,740
2	2013-2014	97,524
3	2014-2015	114,816
4	2015-2016	191,920
5	2016-2017	241,040
6	2018-2019	48,035.26
7	2019-2020	60,453.2
8	2020-2021	No sales during pandemic
9	2021-2022	
10	2022-2023	

4. Description of NWFP present in the area

The Sarphu Broom Grass group has been harvesting the broom only from their privately registered land and has not *designated any SRF land* until now. The collection of broom grass from private registered land shall be guided by the forestry official based on FNCA and FNCRR 2023.

However, after this revision, they will be allowed to collect and sell other NWFP species like *Piper* spp. (Pipla) which are grown naturally within their Chiwog in addition to *Thysanolaena latifolia* (Kucho).

5. Location and Potential NWFP Management Areas

Table 2. Potential NWFP for the group

Name of the area/location	Total area, ac (approx.)	Walking distance	Potential NWFP		
Sarphu Chiwog	15	10 mins.	Broom (Bundles)	Rukh pipla	Bhuin Pipla
			500-1,000.	-	-

6. Description of NWFP for commercial harvesting in each season

Table 3. Commercial harvesting of NWFP species

NWFP Name	Harvesting Area(s) (name)	Parts harvested	Use/Purpose (traditional and others)	Harvesting season (Months)	Estimated quantity for harvest in a season/year
Broom	Sarphu Chiwog	Broom	Broom	December to March	500-1,000 bundles
Pipla		Fruits	medicines	Mid-September	100-500 kg
Bamboo		Stem	Poles	January-December	1,000-1,500 pcs

7. Prescription for sustainable harvesting of NWFPs.

Table 4. Prescriptions or harvesting guidelines for NWFPs

NWFP Species	Harvesting prescription
<i>Thysanolaena latifolia</i> (Kucho)	The species should be harvested from December to March. The basic guidelines for harvesting are: Do not collect all plants from the area. Maintain a few healthy stems in a group. Use proper tools and do not uproot.
<i>Piper</i> spp. (Pipla)	The species can be collected from September to November depending on the type of species. The basic guidelines to be followed: Collect the fruits when fully mature. Do not uproot or cut down the entire climber. Harvest fruits only after the announced date for harvesting. Harvest fruits and spikes by hand picking without damaging the plants or by

	cutting a few bearing branches.
Bamboo	Selective cutting: harvest only matured culms Rotational harvesting: allows previously harvested culm to get adequate time to regenerate. Ensure proper clump management by thinning overcrowded clumps.

8. Marketing and sales plan for the group

Table 5. Marketing strategies and sales plan for the group

NWFP	Potential Market	Estimated quantity to sale annually	Form of products (dry/Fresh)	Expected price per unit	Total (Nu)	Marketing arrangements
Broom	Lhamoizingkha, Gedu, Thimphu and Phuntsholing	500-1000 Bundles	Dry	30/bundle	30,000	The products will be marketed in the Lhamoizingkha and Phuntsholing areas. Additional market opportunities will be explored in other districts and the nearest Indian town.
Pipla	Lhamoizingkha, Gedu, Thimphu and Phuntsholing	100-500 kgs	Dry	100/kg	2500	

9. Benefits to the members

- Free access of products to the members for self-consumption.

10. Benefits to the group

- The funds from the group savings may be used for Community Developmental activities.
- The fund generated from the sale of NWFPs shall be used for development of a common storage unit for the group.
- The NWFPs can be managed sustainably.
- Protection of NWFPs from illicit harvesting and over-exploitation

Part B: By-Laws:**11. Membership Arrangement****11.1. Membership eligibility**

- Households having a registered, either thram or gung are eligible to join the group.
- Households having the traditional rights over the declared forest area for the management of potential NWFPs hold the right to become new members.

11.2. Procedure to become a new member

- Submit the joining application to the chairperson.
- The final decision will be made in the presence of all the group members: New member (s) will be allowed to join the group only after the realization of Nu. 10,000 (Ten Thousand) only as an entry fee.

11.3. Procedure for withdrawing from the group

- Submit the withdrawing application to the chairperson.
- However, the final decision will be made after a close consultation with all the group members
 - With genuine reasons: Withdrawing member (s) with genuine reason will get 50% of his total accumulated budget in the Group's savings. He/She will be allowed to rejoin the group.
 - Without genuine reason: Withdrawing from the group without genuine reason (s) will not get any benefits. He/She will be not allowed to rejoin the group.
- The payment of 50 % of the total annual fee contribution to a withdrawing member will be paid only to the member who withdraws after the completion of the plan cycle. Thus, members withdrawing in between the plan period are not eligible for the 50% share.

12. Roles and Responsibilities of executive members and group members**a. Chairperson**

- Coordinate and monitor group activities.
- Attend and chair any of the group-related meetings.
- Collect and present the market information.
- Implementation of management plan.
- Initiate the seasonal collection of identified NWFPs.
- Maintain the records of activities carried out.
- Maintain and strengthen the relations with other stakeholders and seek technical backstopping from appropriate agencies (ies).
- Obtain NWFP collection permit.
- Attend official correspondences.
- Conflict resolution.

- Joint signatory authority with the treasurer.
- Identify profitable traders/exporter.

b. Secretary

- Officiate Chairperson.
- Guide and monitor the seasonal collection of potentially identified NWFPs.
- Maintain the minutes of the meetings.

c. Treasurer

- Opening of Group account book (Signatory authority with Chairperson).
- Collection and deposition of membership fee.
- Collection and deposition of fines and penalties.
- Maintain and present group's financial records during meetings.
- Maintain records of NWFP collected by the members.
- Assist other executive members in storing collected NWFPs.

d. Members' Roles and Responsibilities

- Labor contribution.
- Election and termination of executive members.
- Auditing.
- Collection of NWFPs as per the prescribed guidelines.
- Participated in any group-related activities.

13. Financial Arrangement

1. Membership fee Nu 100/- will be collected annually. The annual fee will be collected on first week of January month.
2. Deduction of Nu. 20 for 100 bundles broom from member.
3. Deduction of Nu 5 for 1 Kg of *Piper spp* from member.
4. Fines and Penalties:
 - ✓ 100 % of the total fine collected at a time, will be deposited in the group fund.
5. The group fund will be raised from donations and contribution.

13.1. Fund Utilization

Activity	Fund allocated
Purchase of office stationeries /developmental of storage house	5%
Entertaining guests/visitor	5%
Provision for death among members and victims of natural calamities	20%

14. Benefit Sharing

a. Sharing of NWFP resources

- During the resource collecting time, equal collector from each household needs to be ensured by the executive members.
- If he/she is not able to come for collecting the resource (Bamboo, *Pipla*, and broom), the representative may be sent, but should be one of h/h family members
- Only one member can collect the resource from individual household at a time per day
- Collector should be at least 18 years and above.

b. Sharing of financial benefits

- The members will be benefited from 70% of total sale value of product (NWFP) collected by h/h

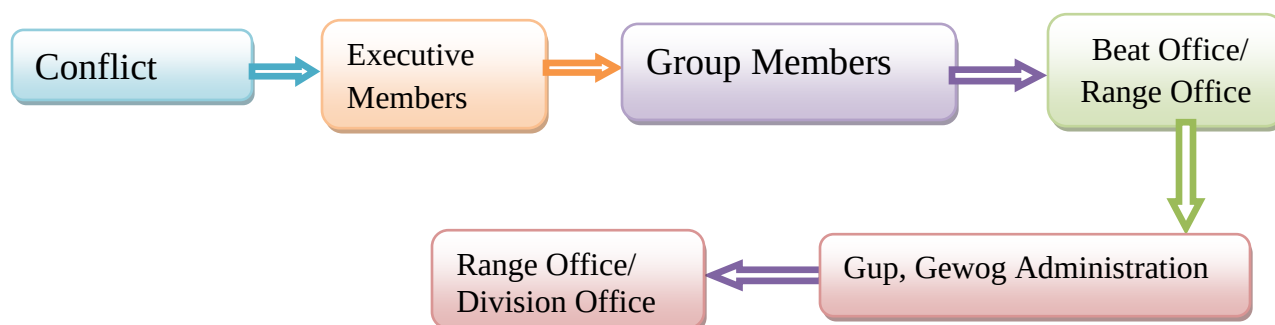
15. Meeting

- General meeting will be conducted twice in a year where executive meeting will be conducted four times a year.
- Executive members can call the presence of group members for any emergency meetings, if necessary.

16. Marketing Arrangement

- Chairman and executive members will find the market and/or trader. (Trader could be outsiders or Bhutanese)
- The group will decide and fixed the product price based on existing market price
- The group will decide in general meeting for the sale of products.
- Group will collect the products and make ready for marketing.
- Treasurer will ensure the proper recording of the products collected by the members.

17. Conflict Resolution



18. Fines and Penalties

Sl.No	Activity	Fines and penalties	Remarks
01.	Any member supplying brooms to other parties than to the group shall be fined	Nu. 25/broom	Products will be released
02.	Collection/extraction of products by the members before/after the prescribed time/season.	Nu.500/-per day per individual	Products will be released
03.	Violation of harvesting guidelines	Nu.25/- per plant	Rehabilitation activities will be done by community
	1. Broom		
	2. <i>Pipla</i>	Nu.25- per plant	
	3. Bamboo	Nu.200/-per plant	
04.	Felling of whole host plant	Report to the nearest forest office for legal action.	
05.	Individual selling of NWFPs	Nu.300/- with the payment of total sale value of the products sold.	
06.	Latecomers in any group-related activities	Nu.300/- only	Suppose he/she arrives after the first 1 hour. He/she will be considered as an absentee.
07.	Absentee	Nu.300/- per day	Will be asked to leave the group after three consecutive warnings.
08.	Misuse of group fund by the treasurer (and executive members)	Refund the total misused fund with the interest (Prevailing govt. interest rate)	Re-election for the post.
09.	Delay in loan refunding	If he/she could not pay the loan on dateline, the principal amount will be double every year.	If he/she is not able to refund the loan even after the passage of three consecutive datelines, the matter will be forwarded to the Geog Administration and/or follow the conflict resolution procedures.

19. Monitoring of activities

- The monitoring of illegal activities in the Sarphu NWFP designated area will be done by the NWFP group members, coordinated by the Chairman and committee members.
- The collection of identified NWFPs will be monitor by the chairman and Committee members with the assist from forest officials.

- Monitoring of Plan implementation will be done by the NWFP collection and marketing group members with the assist from forest officials.

20. Evaluation of NWFP Collection and Marketing Group Plan

The plan will be evaluated based on the following objectives: -

1	Income generation	✓ Bank balance ✓ Living standard of CFMG
2	Conservation	✓ Improved forest stand
3	Rehabilitate	✓ Area rehabilitates through plantation
4	Protection	✓ Reduce the illicit activities

Annexure 1 Name list of NWFP Management Group, Sarphu Village, Darla Gewog

Sl/No	Name	CID Number	House No	Thram No	Contact No
1	Kaziman Rai	11309001923	Kha-5-947	1569	17995579
2	Passang Lham	10205009585	Kha-5-605	461	17402565
3	Padam Bdr Rai	11309001890	Kha-5-598	425	17925009
4	Sangkha Bdr Rai	11309002109	Kha-5-615	415	
5	Resh Moti Monger	11309002117	Kha-5-616	446	
6	Harka Bdr Rai	11309002135	Kha-5-619	449	17526410
7	Indra Bdr Rai	11309002099	Kha-5-911	2206	
8	Nima Dukpa	11309002004	Kha-5-608	452	
9	Narad Bdr Rai	11309002145	Kha-5-651	421	17747851
10	Dil Maya Rai	11309002023	Kha-5-628	435	
11	Bakta Bdr Rai	11309002126	Kha-5-618	436	17995602
12	Surja Man Rai	11309002124	Kha-5-617	443	
13	Bal Krishna Rai	11309002087	Kha-5-614	467	77303119
14	Moti Maya Rai	11309007693	Kha-5-785	1404	

Sl/No	Name	CID Number	Designation	Contact No
1	Kaziman Rai	11309001923	Chairman	17995579
2	Padam Bdr Rai	11309001890	Treasurer	17925009
3	Passang Lham	1130900	Secretary	17402565

Annexure XX
Certification of Origin for Harvesting and Movement of Forest Produce

ROYAL GOVERNMENT OF BHUTAN
MINISTRY OF ENERGY & NATURAL RESOURCES
Department of Forests and Park Services

Certificate of Origin

Name of Permit Holder

CID No: House No: Village:

Approval Reference No.....

Source (From)..... Destination (To):

Vehicle No..... Driver Name:

NWFP Species to be collected:

Type of Forest Produce	Species	Measurement details	Quantity (specify)	Royalty Rate	Amount	Remarks

Nu. (in words)

Date of issue: Valid up to:

Issued by:

Name and signature of Issuing Authority:

Designation:

Name of Division/Park:

Annexure XXII
Internal Movement Order for NWFP

ROYAL GOVERNMENT OF BHUTAN
MINISTRY OF ENERGY & NATURAL RESOURCES
Department of Forests and Park Services

Name of the Division/Park:

Name of the permit holder/buyer:

CID No:

Address:

Source (Form): Destination (To):

Vehicle Number:

Ref; Certificate of Origin:

Type of NWFP	Quantity/Volume	Unit	Remarks
Total			

Royalty realized vide money receipt: date:

Date of issue:

Name and signature of issuing authority

Note: A copy of Certificate of Origin shall be attached